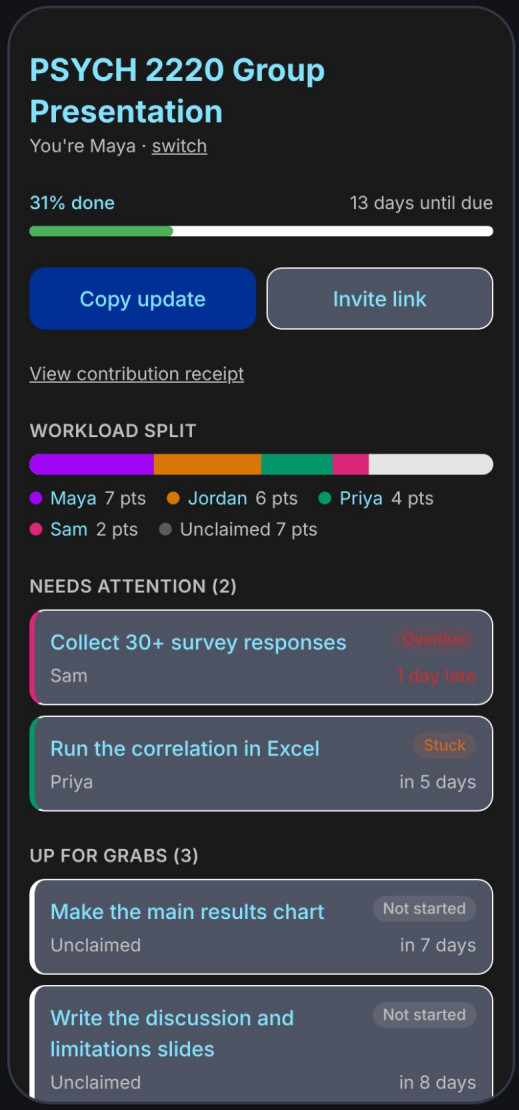
HACKOHI/O 2026 · OPEN CHALLENGE

Carry

Stop carrying your group project.

A fair plan, a tracker that lives in your group chat, and proof of who did what.

Faraz Ayub · Preston Laryea · Thomas Dyer



One person ends up carrying the group.

61%

of students felt their own contribution wasn’t reflected in the group mark they received.

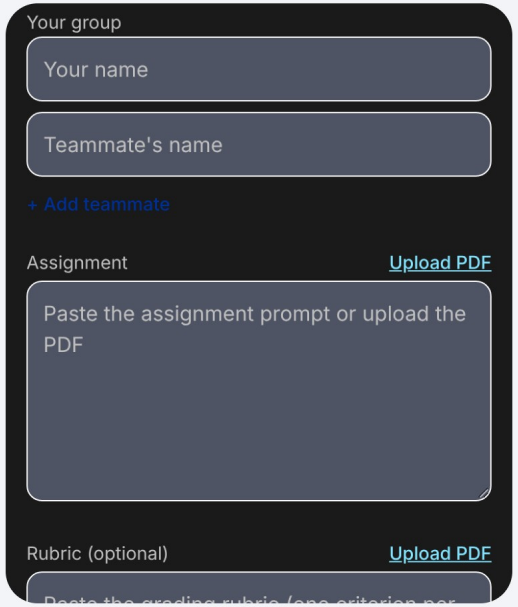
- Group projects run in Snapchat and iMessage chats, where work gets split unevenly and deadlines slip.
- Professors grade the group, so each person’s effort is invisible.
- Peer evaluations come down to memory and vibes.

Source: Hall & Buzwell, “The problem of free-riding in group projects,” Active Learning in Higher Education (2013)

What groups use today

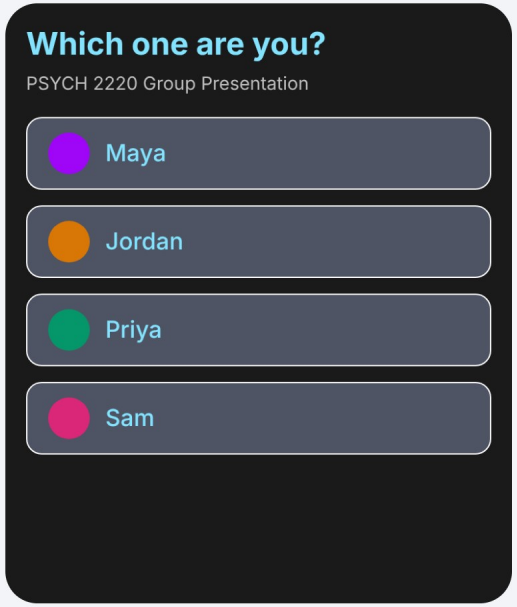
Option	What works	What breaks
Group chat (Snapchat, iMessage)	Everyone is already there	No plan, no owners, no record of who did what
Task boards (Trello, Asana, Notion)	Real structure and deadlines	Built for workplaces: accounts and setup before anyone can join
End-of-term peer evaluations	Gives the professor a signal	Written from memory after the work is over
Carry	Plan, tracker and receipt in one link	Joins from the chat in one tap; credit comes from an activity log

How it works



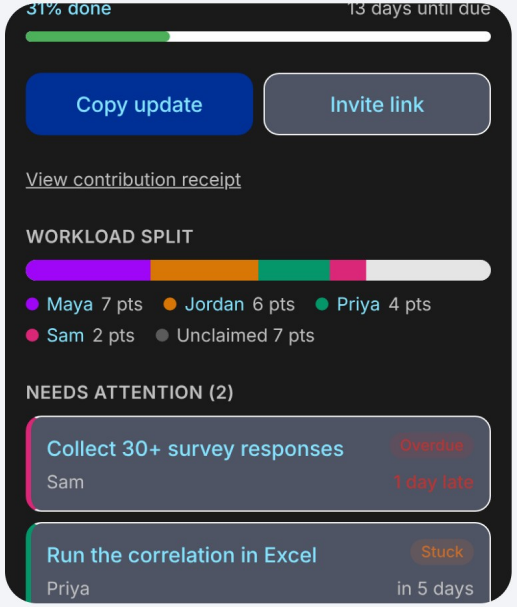
1 Paste the assignment

Or upload the PDFs. Claude drafts 6–10 tasks with effort points and early deadlines.



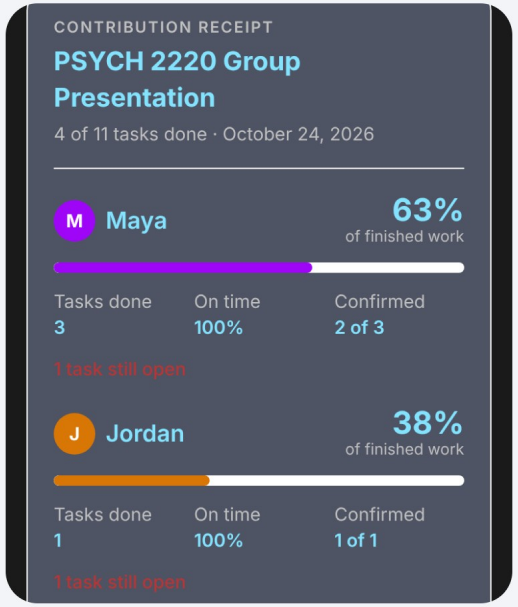
2 Share one link

Teammates open it from the group chat and tap their name. No accounts.



3 Work the dashboard

Claim tasks, see the workload split, and spot stuck or overdue work.



4 Get the receipt

Each person's share of finished effort, on-time rate and confirmations.

LIVE DEMO

Try the demo group

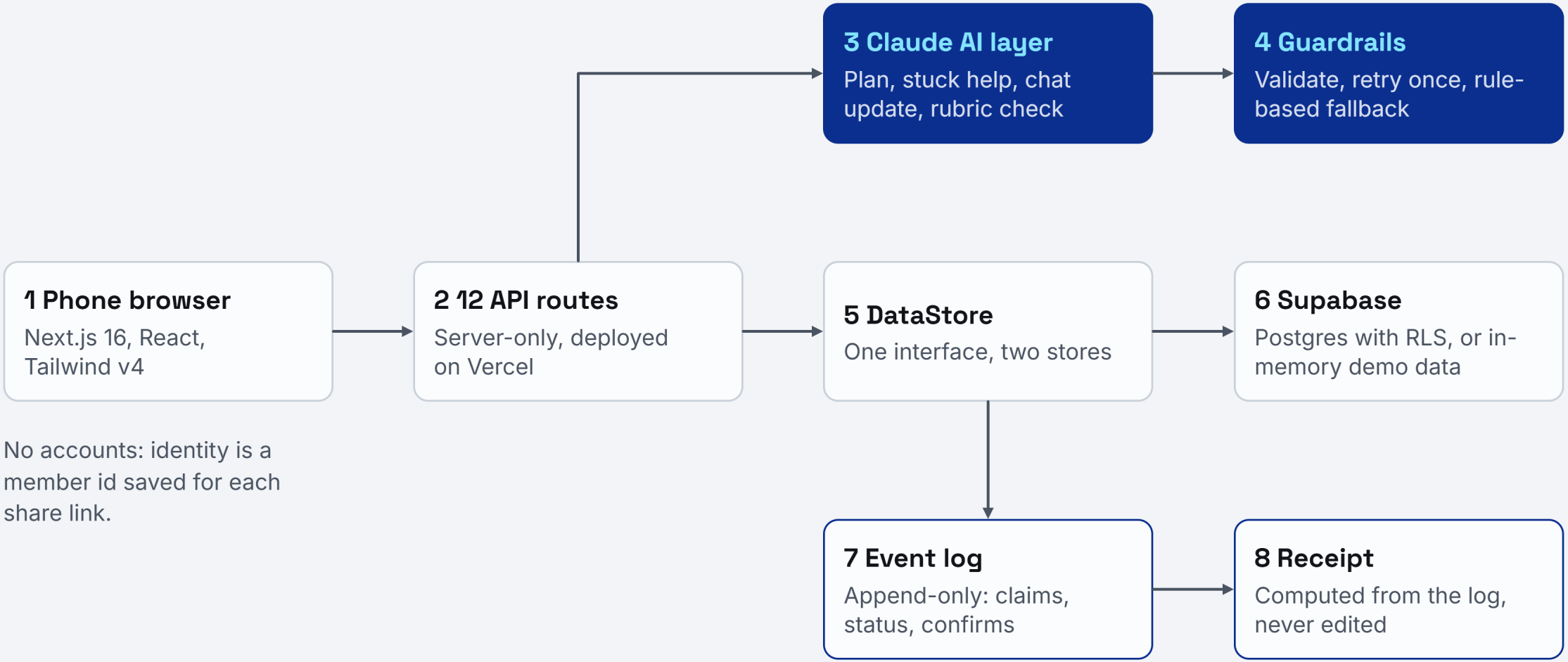
carry-alpha.vercel.app/p/demo42

Four students, one PSYCH 2220 presentation. Maya is carrying, Priya is stuck, and Sam is a day late.



Scan to open the demo

How it’s built



No accounts: identity is a member id saved for each share link.

AI drafts. Code decides what's fair.

Questions we asked while building, and the answer we wrote into code.

What if the model picks a bad deadline?

Every internal deadline is clamped to at least 2 days before the real due date, after the model replies.

Who should help when someone is stuck?

Workload math picks the teammate with the lightest load. The model only writes the next steps.

How do we stop people crediting themselves?

You can't confirm your own task. Only a teammate's confirmation counts on the receipt.

Can credit be rewritten later?

No. Every claim, status change and confirmation is appended to a log, and the receipt is computed from it.

What broke, and how we pivoted

What broke	What we did instead
Snapchat and iMessage don’t allow bots, so Carry can’t post in the chat.	Carry drafts a neutral progress update; one tap copies it to paste in.
Model replies broke our JSON parsing: extra prose and raw line breaks.	A tolerant parser and validator, one stricter retry, then rule-based fallbacks. Every feature works with no AI.
Rubrics usually arrive as PDFs, not text students can paste.	Added PDF upload that pulls out the text for the planner.
A slow API call or bad Wi-Fi could freeze the demo.	A 25-second AI timeout, plus an in-memory store with demo data that runs with zero setup.

Who it helps, and what's next

WHO IT HELPS

Students get a fair split, early deadlines and proof of their work.

Professors and TAs get evidence for peer evaluations instead of memory.

77 → 86

Average team project grade before and after peer evaluations counted toward the grade, across 873 students.

AT 10× SCALE

- Import assignments and rubrics from Canvas (Carmen at Ohio State)
- An instructor view of receipts across every group in a course
- Private email nudges, already modeled in the event log
- Stateless API and Postgres: more groups means more rows, not a rewrite

Source: O'Neill, Boyce & McLarnon, Frontiers in Education (2020)

THANK YOU

Stop carrying your group project.

carry-alpha.vercel.app

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github.com/farazayub06/carry